

Rumi

Small fires, lit on purpose. — Brand Bible

Where the name comes from

The name Rumi borrows its warmth from Jalal ad-Din Rumi, the 13th-century poet whose writing returns again and again to light, love, and quiet reflection — "Let the beauty of what you love be what you do." A candle is a small, physical version of that idea: a flame you light on purpose, in a room you want to feel different in.

The brand is built around three ideas, in this order of importance: **light, not just scent** — every product description, photo, and page centers on the ritual of lighting a candle before it centers on specifications; **warmth over noise** — Rumi earns attention through restraint, not superlatives; and **made by hand** — hand-poured is a fact to be shown (pour dates, batch numbers, small imperfections), not only claimed.

Premium, gift-led RECOMMENDED

This follows from the luxury-and-elegant visual direction: a mid-to-upper price point, sold as much for gifting — birthdays, weddings, festivals, corporate hampers — as for personal use. It's a recommendation, not a fixed decision: if pricing lands closer to mass-market, soften the gold/wine palette toward lighter tints rather than rebuilding the system.

Primary audience

Women and men, roughly 22–45, urban/metro India, who already buy from D2C or aesthetic-led Instagram brands. They notice packaging and photography quality before they read a single spec.

What Rumi is not

Not a budget or mass-volume candle brand, not a clinical/wellness-lab aesthetic, not loud or meme-driven in tone.

A note on the name

Rumi is *inspired by* the poet's themes of light, love and reflection — never presented as an affiliation with or endorsement by his estate or work. Before print runs or paid media, run the trademark/domain/handle checklist in the Build Spec's Legal & Brand Protection section.

Pricing communication: prove "priced for a real gift budget" rather than asserting it — one concrete line near the price on every product page ("Burns for roughly 40 hours — about ₹22/hour of light"), never "incredible value."

Why Rumi exists

Home fragrance in India sits at two extremes — mass-produced paraffin candles sold on price, or imported luxury priced out of reach for most gifting budgets. Rumi exists in between: a candle worth giving and worth keeping lit, priced for a real gift budget, not a duty-free shelf.

Mission

To make small-batch, hand-poured candles that turn ordinary rooms and moments into something someone chose to slow down for.

Core customer problem

People want to give something considered, without the time to source it themselves or the risk of a brand that looks hand-made but burns unevenly.

What makes Rumi different

Small batches with visible pour dates and batch numbers · built around the lit-candle ritual, not a spec sheet · restraint as the differentiator in a category that competes on louder packaging.

Values

Warmth over noise · Honesty in craft · Considered gifting · Quiet quality · Unhurried pace

Vision

Short-term: the considered, hand-poured gift-candle choice for metro India. **Long-term:** a small home-fragrance house — candles, then diffusers and room mists — in the same restrained voice.

Promise

"We make small-batch candles that turn ordinary moments into intentional rituals."

Positioning statement

"Rumi is a premium Indian candle brand built around intentional lighting rituals, sensory storytelling, and the quiet character of things made by hand."

Warm, unhurried, considered, poetic (lightly), honest

Write in first person plural — never a distant corporate "the company." Short sentences, one idea each. Sensory, concrete language over abstract adjectives: not "a luxurious fragrance experience," instead "cedarwood and a little smoke, like a fireplace in an old library." One quiet, poetic line is welcome per page — never stacked. No exclamation marks in body copy.

CONTEXT	TONE	EXAMPLE
Homepage hero	Warm, spare	"Small fires, lit on purpose."
Product description	Concrete, sensory	"Amber and sandalwood, poured into blackened terracotta. Burns for roughly 40 hours."
WhatsApp confirmation	Friendly, plain	"Got it — 2x Amber Dusk (large) for Aarav. We'll confirm your total shortly."
Error / out of stock	Honest, helpful	"This one's sold out for now. The Wine Ember jar is a close cousin — want to see it?"
Packaging insert	Personal, unhurried	"Poured by hand in small batches. Trim the wick to 5mm before each light."

Avoid

Startup-speak ("game-changing," "elevate your space"), all-caps sale banners, countdown timers, emoji inline in sentences.

Starting concept — not final artwork

No logo exists yet. Below is a first-pass direction for a type designer to refine: an italic serif wordmark where the dot of the "i" is replaced by a small flame. Everything else stays purely typographic.



Rumi i

Usage rules once finalized

Clear space equal to the flame glyph's height on all sides. On paper/sand backgrounds: wordmark in wine. On charcoal/dark backgrounds: wordmark in paper, flame stays gold always. Never stretch, rotate, shadow, or badge the mark. Favicon: the flame glyph alone on a charcoal or wine square.

The palette

Paper
#FBF6EE
Primary page background

Ink
#211D1A
Primary text on light surfaces

Charcoal
#2A2622
Footer, dark overlays, admin shell

Gold
#C6A15B
Primary accent, buttons, flame mark

Gold deep
#A9823F
Hover / pressed state for gold

Wine
#6E2A3A
Wordmark, badges, seasonal tags

Sand
#E4D8C3
Cards, inputs, dividers

Sage
#5B6C58
Natural-ingredient badges only

White
#FFFFFF
Product photography cards

Disabled
#A09788
Disabled button/input state only

FOREGROUND ON BACKGROUND	RATIO	USE
Ink on paper	15.6:1	Body text, light theme
Charcoal-ink text on charcoal surface	12.8:1	Body text inside dark sections
Ink on sand	11.9:1	Body text on cards/inputs
Wine on paper	9.5:1	Body text, wordmark
Gold on charcoal	6.2:1	Text/icons in dark sections
Gold-deep on paper	3.3:1	Large text (18px+ bold) and UI only
Gold on paper	2.3:1	Fails — fills/borders/icons only, never text

Measured, not estimated

Every ratio above is a calculated WCAG 2.1 contrast, not a rounded guess. Gold on paper fails even the large-text minimum — never set any text in gold on a paper background; use gold-deep (large text only) or wine instead.

Fraunces + Work Sans

Fraunces (display) carries the poetic, hand-made character for headlines and product names. Work Sans (body) stays neutral so it never competes with photography. Never more than two typefaces on one screen; never bold Fraunces beyond weight 500.

display-xl / 64 Small fires

h1 / 32 Amber Dusk

h3-italic / 21 *lit on purpose.*

body-lg / 18 Cedarwood and a little smoke, like a fireplace in an old library.

body / 15 Poured by hand in small batches. Trim the wick to 5mm before each light.

label-upper / 12 **SOY WAX · HAND-POURED**

08 · PHOTOGRAPHY & IMAGERY

Natural window light, warm color grade, shallow depth of field — no ring-light studio look as the primary style. Show the candle lit, in a lived-in setting, more often than bare product-on-white. Styling props pull from the palette (linen, ceramics, dried flowers); never a competing bright color. Always show one unboxing moment per collection.

Technique: meter for the flame, not the room — exposing for ambient light blows out the glow. Use one warm practical light source (never mixed with a cool overhead light). Capture wisp/smoke shots just after blowing the candle out. Stabilize the phone in low light — handheld low-light shots are the most common source of off-brand results.

09 · ICONOGRAPHY

Thin line icons (1.5px stroke), rounded caps. The flame glyph is the one recurring motif — favicon, loading state, section divider. Buttons/badges: full pill radius. Cards/modals: medium radius. Hero imagery: large radius. Never a sharp 0px corner anywhere.

10 · PACKAGING & LABEL COPY

Hierarchy: product name → scent notes in two or three words → burn time → one care line. Materials: kraft/matte boxes in paper or sand tones, one wine or gold foil-effect sticker bearing the flame mark, tissue paper in paper or sand. Avoid glossy lamination.

Legal Metrology (Packaged Commodities) Rules: India requires MRP, net quantity, and the complete manufacturer/packer name and postal address (a phone number alone is not sufficient), plus month/year of manufacture — confirm exact wording with a professional before print.

11 · APPLYING THE BRAND TO THE SITE

Paper for nearly the whole site; charcoal only for the footer and hero overlays. Gold for every primary call-to-action, including the floating WhatsApp button's resting ring (the WhatsApp glyph itself keeps WhatsApp's own green). Motion stays slow and gentle — 250–350ms ease — echoing candlelight, never bouncy app-like easing. WhatsApp reads as a concierge channel for a hesitant gift-buyer, not a "site's broken" support fallback.

Reference implementations

Built directly from the tokens, not redrawn by hand — live, working versions sit in this Brand Bible's Components tab. If a developer's build drifts from what's shown here, treat this as correct.

Add to cart

Ask on WhatsApp

🔥 Placing order...

Add to cart

NEW

SOY WAX

IN STOCK

SOLD OUT

● Added Amber Dusk to your cart.

● Couldn't reach the server.

PHONE NUMBER

PINCODE

98765 43210

00000

Not a valid pincode.

product photo

Amber Dusk
Amber · Sandalwood · Smoke
₹899

Rumi

Shop About Track order

Rumi

Hand-poured in Pune, India · Privacy · Terms

Do

Let photography and whitespace carry the page. Use gold sparingly enough that it still reads as special. Keep one poetic line per page; everything else plain and concrete. Show the hand-made process in photography and copy.

Don't

Don't use pure black or pure white as a page background. Don't add a second accent color for a single campaign without updating this system. Don't write body copy in Fraunces. Don't use countdown timers or manufactured urgency language (a quiet, factual low-stock line like "Only 4 left in this batch" is honest data, not this, and is fine). Don't let the flame glyph's color change across contexts — it is always gold. Don't set body or label text in gold on a paper background — use gold-deep (large text only) or wine. Don't let native browser form-validation styling override the Input error state, and don't ship a generic toast/modal library's default shadow-heavy look — restyle it or use the components above.

Pair this Brand Bible with the Rumi Build Spec for how these tokens map to real components, pages, and the admin panel.